

Business Canvas Project — Assignment 1.1-1.2

CED Tasks 1–2: Customer Problem + Competitive Advantage

Due: ____ **Team size:** Individual or teams of up to 3 **Submission:** Completed Business Canvas sections (Customer Problem + Market) + supporting documents

This is the **first part** of your Business Canvas Project checkpoint. In this assignment, you identify a customer problem and analyze the market around it. In Assignment 1B, you will validate the problem through interviews, develop a product, test a hypothesis, and define your vision — all building on the **same business idea** you start here.

CED Tasks covered:

- **Task 1:** "Identify and describe a customer's problem, need, or want."
- **Task 2:** "Develop a plan to seek competitive advantage in a potential market."

Deliverables

Canvas Section	What You Submit	AP Topic	CED Task
Customer	Problem statement	1.4	Task 1
Market	Competitor analysis + competitive advantage plan	1.2	Task 2

SECTION 1: CUSTOMER — Problem Statement

AP Topic 1.4 · CED Task 1: "Identify and describe a customer's problem, need, or want."

1A. Customer Problem, Need, or Want

AP Alignment: LO 1.1.A · EK 1.1.A.1, 1.1.A.2, 1.1.A.3

Describe the customer problem, need, or want that your business will address.

Target customer: (Who specifically has this problem? Be precise — age, location, situation. This is the person who **purchases** your product.)

Consumer: (Who **uses** the product? Is the consumer the same as the customer, or different? Explain — EK 1.1.A.2)

Problem, need, or want: (What is the problem? What do they currently do about it? Why is the current solution unsatisfactory?)

How I identified this problem: (What strategy did you use — observation, personal experience, conversations, research? This will be expanded in Assignment 1B with formal interviews.)

Evidence this problem exists: (What have you observed or heard that confirms this problem is real?)

Self-check:

- ☐ I have identified a **specific** customer, not "everyone" — EK 1.1.A.2
- ☐ I have distinguished between **customer** (buyer) and **consumer** (user) — EK 1.1.A.2
- ☐ I have described a **problem, need, or want**, not just a product idea — EK 1.1.A.3
- ☐ I have explained **how** I identified this problem — LO 1.1.A

SECTION 2: MARKET — Competitors + Competitive Advantage

AP Topic 1.2 · CED Task 2

2A. Market Description and Competitors

AP Alignment: LO 1.2.A · EK 1.2.A.1, 1.2.A.2 · LO 1.2.B · EK 1.2.B.1, 1.2.B.2, 1.2.B.5, 1.2.B.6

Market description: My business will operate in the ___ market (local / regional / global). This is a physical / virtual / both space where sellers interact with buyers (EK 1.2.A.1).

How competitive is this market? (How many rivals? How differentiated are their products? How price-competitive? — EK 1.2.B.2)

Competitor Table:

Competitor	What they offer	Direct or Indirect?	What they do well	What they miss (your opportunity)	Barrier to entry they create? (explain)

How voluntary exchange creates value:

When my customer buys my product, they get ___ (value for the buyer). In exchange, I receive ___ (revenue for the seller). This is the voluntary exchange that EK 1.2.A.2 describes.

Self-check:

- ☐ I have identified the **market** my business operates in — EK 1.2.A.1
- ☐ I have assessed **how competitive** the market is — EK 1.2.B.2
- ☐ I have identified **at least 2 competitors** — direct and/or indirect
- ☐ I have explained **voluntary exchange** — value for buyer, revenue for seller — EK 1.2.A.2
- ☐ I have considered **barriers to entry** — EK 1.2.B.6

2B. Competitive Advantage Plan

AP Alignment: LO 1.2.B · EK 1.2.B.1, 1.2.B.3, 1.2.B.5, 1.2.B.6

Competitive advantage = the ability to outperform rivals, leading to increased market share and potentially increased profits (EK 1.2.B.1).

My competitive strategy: (Choose one or more from EK 1.2.B.5 and explain why it fits your market — EK 1.2.B.3)

- ☐ **Differentiation** — my product is better / unique / has features competitors don't
- ☐ **Cost leadership** — I can offer a similar product at a lower price
- ☐ **Niche strategy** — I serve a specific segment competitors ignore

How I will demonstrate superiority over rivals: (Higher quality? Unique features? Better service? Lower price? More effective marketing? — EK 1.2.B.5)

Barriers to entry that protect my business: (IP? Regulations? Startup costs? Scale? — EK 1.2.B.6)

Barriers to entry that I face: (What obstacles make it hard for ME to enter this market?)

Self-check:

- ☐ I have chosen a **specific competitive strategy** — EK 1.2.B.5
- ☐ I have explained **why** this strategy fits my market — EK 1.2.B.3
- ☐ I have considered **barriers to entry** from both sides — EK 1.2.B.6

Grading Rubric

Section	Excellent (A)	Good (B)	Developing (C)	Needs Work (D/F)
1A — Customer problem (1.1)	Specific customer/consumer distinction, clear problem, evidence of how identified, all EK referenced	Clear problem, customer identified, most EK referenced	Vague customer or problem, some EK missing	No clear problem or EK not referenced
2A — Market & competitors (1.2)	Market described, 2+ competitors, voluntary exchange explained, barriers considered	Market identified, competitors listed, some barrier analysis	Incomplete competitors, no barrier analysis	Missing or incorrect analysis
2B — Competitive advantage (1.2)	Specific strategy chosen and justified, barriers from both sides, fits market competitiveness	Strategy chosen, some justification	Generic strategy, weak justification	No strategy or incorrect application

Important Notes

- Same business idea across both assignments.** The business idea you choose here will carry forward into Assignment 1B (validation, product, PESTEL). Choose something you're genuinely interested in.
- Team size:** Individual or teams of up to 3. All members must contribute. Each team submits one set of deliverables.
- You may refine later.** This is a first draft of your Customer and Market sections. After Assignment 1B (interviews + hypothesis testing), you may revise based on what you learn.

4. **This is not a business plan.** You are not expected to launch a real business. You are expected to **demonstrate the essential knowledge and skills** from Topics 1.1–1.2.